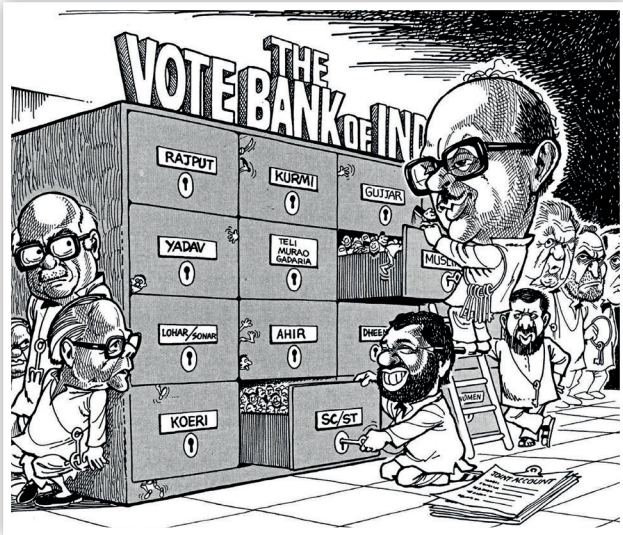
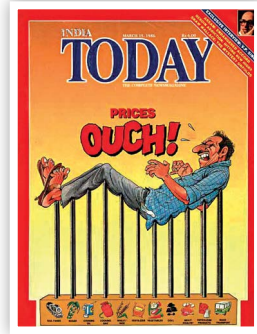












March 15, 1986

ist, illustrator and graphic designer, transitioning seamlessly through technological changes.

What that gave us was a masterful visual complement to textual journalism. With a strain of humour that never strayed towards combative anger or the darker tones of cynicism, either in his personality or in his cartooning, what we got was astute political commentary—in real life and on page. If he kept a straight face when amidst colleagues, and not absorbed in his craft, it was only the tautness of a joke about to be told. His single images were often all that needed to be said on the subject—for proof, see only the March 15, 1986, cover in our collage, the price graph piercing the common man's derriere. But where he truly excelled was in the sprawling canvas, the mise en scène that contained a chronicle of our follies in every tiny detail. "Leaders make for great cartoons. I don't know what that says about the country, but it makes my job much easier and lots of fun," Ninan said once. Those who take themselves too seriously tend to become balloons for his darts. Gods better watch out. ■